

Muncie Redevelopment Commission October 16, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Um35Q2eVDmk
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer. The transcript captures regular board proceedings including claims approval, financial position updates, program updates, and business proposals.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Dale, Mr. Bishop, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, and Ms. Waggley (Note: Last name also referenced phonetically as Wagner in parts of the transcript).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening remarks, but leading the proceedings.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None noted in this portion of the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:00:02 Mr. Dale raised a motion regarding the approval of minutes from a prior special meeting, noting concerns regarding the lack of an amortization schedule on a 10-year note, lack of a personal guarantee from the buyer for a city loan, lack of explanation for MRC's continued maintenance and operations

participation (\$437,000 over 10 years), and discussions surrounding video recording and open-door law compliance.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 3-2 (Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, and Mr. Pilla voted Yes; Mr. Miller and Ms. Wagglely voted No).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

Item 1: 00:01:54 Monthly Claims Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig
- **Deliberation Summary:** Craig presented the monthly claims, noting a light volume. Board members inquired about an invoice for “river area, multiple tree plantings,” which Craig clarified were locations dictated by the parks department.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved Unanimously by Roll Call (Mr. Bishop, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, and Ms. Wagglely voted Yes).

Item 2: 00:03:03 Financial Position & Facade Grant Rollover Discussion

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership / Staff
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed the monthly financial update. The board discussed that funds allocated for the facade grant must be spent within the current calendar year unless officially decided otherwise by the board. Members agreed to add the rollover question to next month’s agenda for formal debate. Additionally, Mr. Bishop provided an update on the facade grant program, stating 5 or 6 applications have been received and are moving toward final approval next month.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion; no formal vote taken.

Item 3: 00:06:21 Lease of Coulson Property (Telecommunications RFP)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. How / Board Leadership
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed a single proposal received by the October 13, 2025 deadline in response to the RFP to lease the challenged, flood-zone-limited Coulson property (1700 block North Coulson Drive) for telecommunications use. Atlas Tower 1 LLC submitted a proposal to lease the property for a 360-month term (with four 5-year extensions) offering a monthly rental of \$500 plus a one-time payment of \$96,000, alongside constructing a 125-foot monopole telecommunications tower to address coverage and first-responder communication gaps. After initial debates regarding expediency versus tabling, the board moved forward with approval contingent on legal review, zoning approval, and staff finalization of terms.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, and Ms. Waggley voted Yes).

Item 4: 00:14:57 Muncie Land Bank Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard, Muncie Land Bank
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Nate Howard provided updates on Land Bank funding (highlighting new support from Ball Brothers and Centerpoint Energy Foundation), the sale and local rehab commitment for 913 West Kilgore, acquisition of 5 properties from the county, and the purchase of 13 certificates at the recent tax sale (including 2 homes and 1 garage tied to Old West End, Whitley, and Industry neighborhoods). Howard also reported on recent Ball State research partnerships regarding renter experiences and ongoing community engagement surveys in Industry.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no formal board action required.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:19:17 Resident Speaker 1:** Commented on visual improvements from ongoing park/river work, inquired about the status of "Ready 2.0" development funding, and raised concerns regarding taxpayer financial exposure and maintenance contributions toward the Promenade parking garage while public access is restricted.
 - **00:23:23 Janna Oliver: 00:23:27** Asked for clarification on how citizens can access information regarding county tax sales and whether individuals can purchase properties through the process.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Commissioners discussed open-door laws, meeting video archiving responsibilities, and clarified that a prior special meeting was recorded independently by press/university reporters rather than the city.
 - **Adjournment: 00:27:13** The meeting was officially adjourned until the next scheduled meeting on **November 20th, 2025**.
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